

LUIS CALDERON

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Affiliation

University of Bonn
Institute for Macroeconomics
and Econometrics
Kaiserplatz 7-9, 53113 Bonn, Germany

Personal

Citizenship: American (German in progress)
Hometown: Miami, FL
Ethnicity: Latino
Languages: English (native),
Spanish (native), German (B1–B2)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, household heterogeneity, monetary and fiscal policy, oil supply shocks, Bayesian econometrics, functional data analysis, semi-structural time-series methods

POSITIONS

University of Bonn

Postdoctoral Researcher, Institute for Macroeconomics and Econometrics

Starting August 2026

EDUCATION

University of Bonn, Germany

Ph.D. in Economics
M.Sc. in Economics with a specialization in research

October 2020 – Present

University of Bonn, Germany

M.Sc. in Economics

October 2018 – October 2020

Florida International University, Miami, FL

B.B.A. in Finance
B.A. in Economics, *Minor in Mathematics*

August 2013 – December 2017

REFERENCES

Christian Bayer
University of Bonn
Institute for Macroeconomics
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Moritz Kuhn
University of Mannheim
Department of Economics
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Benjamin Born
University of Bonn
Institute for Macroeconomics
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Farzad Saidi
University of Bonn
Institute for Finance
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WORKING PAPERS (ABSTRACTS BELOW)

“Distributional Dynamics”, with Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn. CEPR Discussion Paper 19829. [Link](#).

“Not All Oil Supply Shocks are Alike: The Macroeconomic and Distributional Impact of Oil Supply Shocks”. Preliminary draft (May 2026). [Link](#).

“Oil Supply Shocks and Monetary Policy”. Preliminary draft (June 2026). [Link](#).

“Spatial Standard Errors for Several Commonly Used M-estimators”, with Leander Heldring. *R&R at the International Journal of Computational Economics and Econometrics*. [Link](#).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Distributional Dynamics: Germany”, with Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn

“Monetary Policy According to Data”

“Distributional Counterfactuals”

“Sectoral Job Levels and Productivity”, with Christian Bayer, Moritz Kuhn and See-Yu Chan. [Slides](#).

“The Fiscal Roots of Wealth Inequality: Corporate Concentration and the Eroding Tax Base”

CONFERENCE, SEMINAR & WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

2026

- Annual Conference of the Central Bank of Brazil (Banco Central do Brasil)
- North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society (June)
- CESifo Area Conference on Macro with Micro Data (June, Poster)
- ICMAIF (University of Crete, May)

2025

- CASFI Summer Meeting
- BCFM
- CRC TR 224 Retreat

2024

- Summer Meeting of the SED (Barcelona, Presenter)
- Banca d'Italia (Rome, Poster)
- Money Conference (Board of Governors)
- Center for Advanced Studies in Finance and Inequality (Bonn)
- Firm Heterogeneity and Macroeconomics (Bonn/Mannheim, 2022–2024)

2023

- HANK Conference (Berlin)

SCHOOLS & WORKSHOPS

Summer Schools: Macroeconomics and Financial Markets (June 2022, Dean Corbae), DSE 2024

Spring Schools: Macroeconomics and Big Data (April 2024, Domenico Giannone, Giorgio Primiceri)

Workshops: Empirical Methods in Macroeconomics (May 2024, Christian Wolf)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Bonn Graduate School of Economics

CLASS: Coding in Julia and Stata (PhD)

CLASS: Topics in Inequality (BSc)

CLASS: Macroeconomics I (BSc)

WINTER SCHOOL: BASEforHANK (for PhDs and central bankers)

Winter 2021 – Present

Summer 2024

Summer 2025, Summer 2026

December 2025

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE (AS A RESEARCH ASSISTANT)

Department of Macroeconomics, University of Mannheim

PIs: Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn

PROJECT: Datawork on Job Levels project

January 2024 – September 2024

Institute of Macroeconomics and Econometrics, University of Bonn

PIs: Christian Bayer, Benjamin Born, Ralph Luetticke, and Moritz Kuhn

PROJECT 1: [Shocks, Frictions, and Inequality in US Business Cycles](#)

PROJECT 2: [Distributional Dynamics](#)

PROJECT 3: [BASEforHANK](#)

MASTER THESIS: [The Effects of Income Uncertainty on Liquidity, Default, and Prosperity](#)

June 2020 – Present

Institute on Behavior & Inequality (briq)

PI: [Prof. Leander Heldring](#)

PROJECT 1: [The Cost of State-building: Evidence from Germany](#)

PROJECT 2: [Spatial standard errors for several commonly used M-estimators](#)

May 2019 – June 2020

SUPERVISION OF MASTER THESES

2025: Marius Trovik (1.0)

2024: Zsigmond Szajbely (1.0)

2023: Luke Liscio (1.0)

2022: Islom Juraev (2.3)

2021: Anna Sanchez (1.7)

MEMBERSHIPS AND ROLES

2024 – present: Member of Collaborative Research Center Transregio 224 “Economic Perspectives on Societal Challenges”

2021 – 2024: BGSE Representative

2024 – present: Kreisliga Basketball (PG), Volunteer for U18 games

2022 – present: Bonner Liga Basketball (PG and Treasurer)

2021 – present: NRW Liga Chess Player

“Distributional Dynamics”, with Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn. CEPR Discussion Paper 19829. [Link](#).

Abstract: We develop a new method for deriving high-frequency synthetic distributions of consumption, income, and wealth. Modern theories of macroeconomic dynamics identify the joint distribution of consumption, income, and wealth as a key determinant of aggregate dynamics. Our novel method allows us to study their distributional dynamics over time. The method can incorporate different microdata sources, regardless of their frequency and coverage of variables, to generate high-frequency synthetic distributional data. We extend existing methods by allowing for more flexible data inputs. The core of the method is to treat the distributional data as a time series of functions whose underlying factor structure follows a state-space model, which we estimate using Bayesian techniques. We show that the novel method provides the high-frequency distributional data needed to understand better the dynamics of consumption and its distribution over the business cycle.

“Not All Oil Supply Shocks are Alike: The Macroeconomic and Distributional Impact of Oil Supply Shocks”. [Link](#).

Abstract: Oil supply shocks shape U.S. inequality, and *the type of* oil supply shock matters for who bears the cost. In a Bayesian VAR that embeds the joint distribution of U.S. household income, consumption, and wealth alongside a standard oil-market block, sudden production shortfalls (Baumeister and Hamilton, 2019) raise inequality, whereas oil supply news (Känzig, 2021) mostly reduces it. These differences are not visible in the aggregate dynamics, which appear similar across shocks. A causal mediation analysis (Dufour and Wang, 2024) of these aggregate dynamics shows these shocks operate through distinct channels and it is this mechanism wedge, rather than the aggregate footprint, that determines who bears the cost. The analysis shares the view of Kilian and Lewis (2011) that policy responses should depend on the underlying causes of oil price shocks.

“Oil Supply Shocks and Monetary Policy”. [Link](#).

Abstract: I revisit the role of monetary policy in the transmission of oil supply shocks within a single Bayesian VAR that jointly identifies a Känzig (2021) oil supply news shock and six orthogonal monetary policy shocks. I combine the causal mediation framework of Dufour and Wang (2024), to recover what the Federal Reserve’s reaction function loads on, with the sufficient-statistics counterfactual of Caravello, McKay and Wolf (2024), to evaluate *three* alternative rules: a nominal rate peg, strict CPI-inflation targeting, and an optimal dual-mandate rule. Four findings emerge. (i) Aggregate responses are largely insensitive to the rule at short constraint horizons, with the Fed reacting primarily to inflation, the oil price, and demand-side mediators, and negligibly to the oil-market block. (ii) Policy duration is what discriminates the rules at the macro level: held for only a few quarters the three rules look near-identical, but enforced over the full twenty-quarter horizon the rate peg and dual-mandate converge to one another and deliver materially better output, inflation, and unemployment stability than the realized path. (iii) Distributional responses discriminate even at short horizons: the dual-mandate rule tracks the realized Gini paths, while the rate peg and strict inflation targeting both compress income, wealth, and consumption inequality, with strict- π amplifying the realized compression by roughly twenty per cent for income, two-and-a-half-fold for consumption, and threefold for wealth. (iv) The strict- π compression is driven by redistribution toward the bottom of the distribution rather than top-tail destruction. The cross-section, and the duration over which a rule is held, thus discriminate between rules that headline macro aggregates at short horizons cannot.

“Spatial Standard Errors for Several Commonly Used M-estimators”, with Leander Heldring. [Link](#).

Abstract: We provide a unified implementation of existing asymptotic theory that computes Conley-style spatial HAC standard errors for a wide range of commonly used (non-linear) estimators. We cover OLS, logit, probit, Poisson, and negative binomial regressions, as well as the fixed-effects estimators *areg* and *reghdfe*—extending commonly used publicly available routines (currently limited to linear models) to nonlinear M-estimators and fixed-effects workflows. We provide Stata and Python software implementing the procedure.